

Bazaar



We test the latest and the best hardware and software products available in the market

Sony Ericsson P900

How do you replicate a class act, and then justify the 'new and improved' tag? If ever there was an example that management students can learn from, it's the Sony Ericsson P900 phone-PDA combo. It looks more professional, is smaller, lighter, less clunky and has features ideal for both business and pleasure.

The price (Rs 40,000) puts it off-limits for most of us, but with current smart-phone technology, you could hardly ask for more. The internal 16 MB memory can be boosted using the Memory Stick Duo socket—up to 128 MB.

The P900 offers great functionality as a regular phone, with excellent voice clarity even in areas with low network coverage. The phone's bulk may prevent



those with small hands to hold it, but it must be mentioned that the 65K touchscreen is extremely clear, and the colours are rich. In flip-open mode, the entire LCD screen comes into views, and phone is now a fully functional PDA.

Music playback is good, and though the videos (in MPEG-4 format) seem a little grainy, the pictures (stored in JPEG format) come out pretty well. But make sure the lighting conditions are good.

The integrated digital camera has a resolution of 640 x 480, 320 x 240, or 160 x 120 pixels, allowing you to choose from three types of picture quality—high, medium and low. Videos can be shot for as long as you want, limited only by the

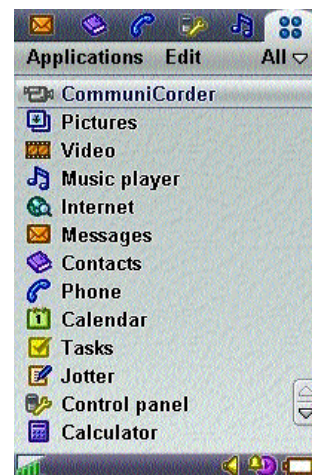
amount of free memory available. Apart from JPEG, the picture viewer supports the BMP, GIF, PNG and WBMP formats.

The device would seem a bit slow while opening some applications, and playing games is not a pleasurable experience at all. Most of all, you miss the full-screen mode, and you need the stylus and a virtual navigation pad to control game objects.

It features a voice recorder and an integrated hands-free speaker. Apart from the T9 numeric keypad and an onscreen virtual keypad, there is also CIC's JotPro that uses character recognition, à la Palm Graffiti, for onscreen writing using the stylus.

Connectivity and data transfer options include Bluetooth, Infra-red, GPRS and HSCSD. Surf the Web using the WAP 2.0 HTML browser. Features such as support for e-mail with attachments and a built-in viewer that can read Microsoft Word and PDF documents, let you do your work on the move.

The PIM features Tasks, a calendar with multiple views, notes, a calculator, and multiple alarms. There's an inbuilt file manager to



The applications installed resemble the Start Menu in Windows

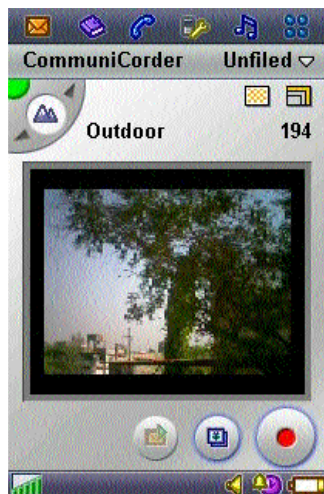
organise stored files in the internal and external memory. The CD also includes the Opera browser.

We were able to pair the device with a desktop PC using a Bluetooth USB adaptor without any hiccups. The lithium polymer battery can last you three days with normal use of the phone, camera, multimedia and PDA features.

- + Stacked to the gills with features
- Slightly expensive

SPECIFICATIONS

Tri-band (GSM E900, 1800, 1900), Symbian OS 7.0, 115 x 57 x 24 mm (with flip), 150 gm, integrated camera, video recorder, GPRS, WAP, HSCSD



Capturing stills or videos on the P900 is simple

Ergonomics (Scale of 5)	
Sony Ericsson P900	4
Nokia 6600	3.5

Price: Rs 40,000
Contact: Sony Ericsson
Phone: 0124-2560808
E-mail: dhiraj.soni@sonyericsson.com
website: www.sonyericsson.com

Sony Ericsson P900	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶